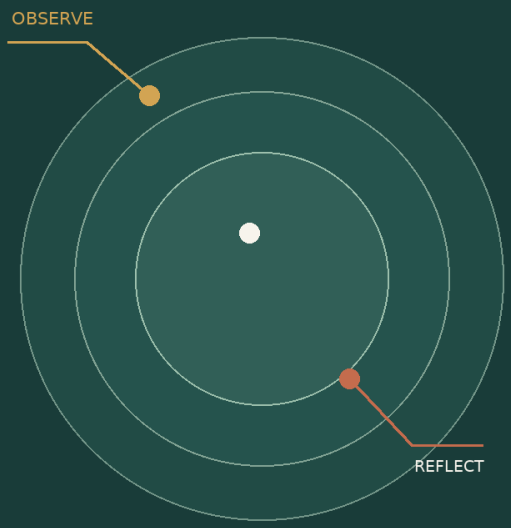
GROWING MINDS SCIENCE

See what's growing.

The Living Field Guide to the Growing Mind



BRAND IDENTITY + EXPERIENCE GUIDELINES

Creative direction / October 2026

THE NORTH STAR

Parents don’t primarily need more instructions. They need better mental models of how their children develop, how their own behavior matters, and what the research actually supports.

A working brand system for design, content, product, and AI-assisted website development.

01 / BRAND STRATEGY

A field guide with a human heartbeat.

Growing Minds Science turns developmental science into understanding parents can carry into real family life.

THE CORE PROMISE

Make the invisible processes of childhood easier to see. A parent should leave more capable of interpreting an unfamiliar moment, not just remembering a script.

What this brand is — and is not

IS	An interactive science field guide	IS NOT	Another parenting advice feed
IS	Rigorous, curious, warm and useful	IS NOT	A cold clinical portal
IS	Practical without being prescriptive	IS NOT	A milestone anxiety dashboard
IS	Playful through discovery	IS NOT	Childish or over-gamified

Three dimensions of understanding

01 UNDERSTAND YOUR CHILD What capacities are developing, how abilities interact, and why everyday behavior can make developmental sense.

02 UNDERSTAND YOURSELF How adult expectations, interpretations, regulation, and history shape the interaction.

03 UNDERSTAND YOUR INFLUENCE What parents can shape through relationships, routines, environments, and responsive interaction — without overpromising control.

Decision filter

Every substantial design decision should answer: Does this help someone observe more carefully, understand more accurately, respond more constructively, or reflect more usefully?

02 / MESSAGING ARCHITECTURE

Four lines. Four different jobs.

These four recommended lines form a coherent brand voice, each with a distinct job rather than acting as interchangeable taglines.

01 PRIMARY BRAND TAGLINE

See what's growing.

Logo lockups, homepage hero, high-level campaigns. Short, ownable, warm, curiosity-driven.

02 EDUCATIONAL PROMISE

The first five years, understood.

Course pages, editorial introductions, platform descriptions. Concrete and intellectually confident.

03 TEACHING PHILOSOPHY

Mental models, not scripts.

About page, pedagogy, internal product reviews. The standard by which educational experiences are judged.

04 PARENT-CENTERED PROMISE

Less pressure. Better explanations.

Parent-facing reassurance, benefit statements, onboarding. Emotionally resonant without guilt or hype.

Supporting language — not additional primary taglines

“There’s more to every moment.” is the strongest editorial campaign line. “Understand first. Respond better.” fits practical learning. “Clear about what’s known. Honest about what’s not.” belongs near scientific transparency and evidence features.

Rule: Never stack all four slogans on one screen. Give each surface one lead message and one supporting thought.

03 / COLOR SYSTEM

Field Notes & Discovery

Warm archival paper, deep evergreen ink, mineral greens and a few purposeful annotations. The palette should feel scientific and human — never like a wellness template.

FOREST INK

#193C39

Primary text / dark brand surfaces

FIELD PAPER

#F7F4EC

Editorial background

DEEP VERDIGRIS

#245F58

Actions / navigation

SAGE MIST

#E0EBE5

Explanatory surfaces

DISCOVERY CLAY

#C46C4D

Annotations / emphasis

GOLDEN OCHRE

#D2A453

Discovery / play accents

RESEARCH BLUE

#426B91

Sources / technical detail

SOFT WHITE

#FFFDF8

Cards / reading surfaces

Color proportions

70% PAPER + WHITE

20% FOREST + VERDIGRIS

10% CLAY + OCHRE + BLUE

These ratios are visual guidance, not strict pixel quotas. Let illustrations use accent colors selectively; reserve deep greens for moments of authority and structure.

Accessibility rules

Forest Ink on Field Paper ≈ 10.9:1; white on Deep Verdigris ≈ 7.4:1; Research Blue on Field Paper ≈ 5.1:1. Discovery Clay on Field Paper ≈ 3.4:1 and white on Clay ≈ 3.8:1: do not use either for normal-sized body text. Ochre should not carry small white text. Test final pairings for WCAG 2.2 AA.

04 / TYPOGRAPHY & IDENTITY

An editorial voice, not a template.

The visual identity should be recognizable through type, proportion, and diagrammatic detail even before a logo is seen.

Preferred typography pair

DISPLAY / EDITORIAL

Newsreader — recommended for headlines, big questions, feature introductions, and thoughtfully set pull quotes.

INTERFACE / READING

Inter — recommended for body copy, tools, buttons, small labels, forms, scientific metadata, and long-reading clarity.

If Newsreader is unavailable in the implementation environment, use a carefully selected editorial serif fallback; consider Instrument Serif + DM Sans as a second direction. Validate licensed font files and performance before deployment.

Specimen / suggested scale

See what's growing.

HERO / DISPLAY, EDITORIAL SERIF

Understand the mind behind the moment.

SECTION HEADLINE, EDITORIAL SERIF

What is your child building in this moment?

INTERFACE PROMPT, SANS-SERIF

Wordmark direction

growing minds / S C I E N C E

Explore a lowercase editorial wordmark with a restrained, widely tracked "SCIENCE" descriptor. The name should feel personable; the descriptor provides precision. Prioritize type before developing a symbol.

Symbol exploration

Avoid literal tree, sprout, cartoon brain, or puzzle-piece marks. Explore a small observation motif — overlapping fields of view, a calibrated lens, or scientific annotation — that could recur subtly in diagrams and product interfaces.

Layout and texture

Use generous whitespace, quiet rules, strong editorial grids, small figure numbering, calm rounded corners, and occasional edge annotations. Avoid stacking heavy colored cards or filling empty space with ornamental icons.

05 / ART DIRECTION

An ordinary moment, newly seen.

Photography shows real childhood; illustration reveals relationships beneath the surface. Their dialogue is the signature of the brand.

Photography: observational, not aspirational

- Prefer authentic families, ordinary rooms, lived-in surroundings, exploratory gestures, concentration, play, and connection.
- Use natural light, considered cropping, and visual diversity without tokenism or staged perfection.
- Avoid generic smiling-family stock, artificially immaculate homes, exaggerated distress, and contrived brain imagery.

Scientific illustration: reveal mechanisms, not decoration

- Use annotated scenes, relationship maps, developmental timelines, conceptual process diagrams, and small-multiple comparisons.
- Build a reusable visual grammar: precise labels, restrained arrows, consistent stroke weights, meaningful accents, and figure captions.
- Label conceptual explanations as conceptual. Do not imply exact causes, neural localization, or individual diagnosis where evidence is incomplete.

Motion: purposeful and calm

Animations should disclose relationships, differences, sequences, or new levels of explanation. Favor quick, low-amplitude transitions; always support reduced motion. Never use movement purely to make the site feel “dynamic.”

Three signature art-direction moves

01 Annotated observation Start with a naturalistic moment; overlay small, beautifully typeset labels when the viewer asks to explore.

02 The explanatory reveal Progressively introduce a simple visual model that links developmental processes to recognizable behavior.

03 Field-guide notation Use quiet scientific metadata — ages, topics, figure IDs, sources — to convey intellectual seriousness without clutter.

THE VISUAL TEST

Would this design still feel like Growing Minds Science with the logo removed? If the answer is no, the typography, colors, compositional rules, and illustration system need greater distinctiveness.

06 / VERBAL IDENTITY

Curiosity without judgment.

Write like a thoughtful developmental scientist who loves explaining ideas and respects the realities of family life.

Three editorial rules

REVEAL, DON'T PRESCRIBE Explain the process before giving advice. Guidance should follow understanding whenever the user has time to engage.

ILLUMINATE, DON'T OVERSIMPLIFY Make research legible without disguising uncertainty, developmental variability, or limits of evidence.

EMPOWER, DON'T PRESSURE Give parents greater interpretive confidence rather than more tasks, guilt, or unrealistic control.

Before → after

AVOID	PREFER
"Unlock your baby's brain potential!"	"How everyday interaction supports early learning."
"Five tricks to stop tantrums."	"What makes transitions difficult for toddlers?"
"Is your child falling behind?"	"Understanding variation — and when to ask questions."
"Science proves this parenting method works."	"What research supports, and what remains uncertain."

Tone balance

Intelligent but not academic; warm but not sentimental; useful but not rigid; confident about evidence without manufacturing certainty. Avoid influencer hype, "hacks," alarmist urgency, and performance-centered parenting language.

Science honesty

Differentiate observation, evidence-supported explanation, practical options, and individualized professional advice. Credit studies accurately; never invent research, citations, numerical effects, or consensus labels.

07 / SIGNATURE EXPERIENCE

The Developmental Lens

A reusable interactive learning pattern that transforms an everyday situation into a transferable way of seeing.

01 **OBSERVE**	**What are we actually seeing?** Start with concrete, recognizable behavior — not a confident guess about the child's motivation.
02 **UNDERSTAND**	**What might be developing?** Reveal relevant capacities and contextual influences with a careful, visually compelling explanatory model.
03 **RESPOND**	**What can this understanding change?** Offer realistic, research-consistent options; do not promise instant behavioral control.
04 **REFLECT**	**What might you notice next time?** Invite observation and curiosity, not monitoring anxiety or an unvalidated child score.

Flagship demonstration

Use a toddler's difficult playground departure. Show the moment, introduce a conceptual model of autonomy and developing flexibility, suggest a few supportive approaches, then invite reflection. Make clear that the model does not diagnose any particular child's motives.

Component requirements

Responsive step navigation; visual explanation with accessible text alternative; lightweight, reduced-motion transitions; age/topic metadata; evidence references; contextual links to relevant classes and tools. Do not force the full interactive sequence on parents seeking immediate help.

08 / WEBSITE EXPRESSION

Make the ecosystem feel like one place.

Organize the existing products around questions and learning journeys, not around a directory of unrelated features.

Proposed navigation

Explore Classes Tools Articles About

Keep Growing Minds AI and “My classes” accessible as utility actions. Preserve a recognizable shortcut for hard moments and urgent practical support.

Three natural entry points

BY AGE An inviting map of development across the first five years, without rigid normative timelines.

BY MOMENT Common everyday situations leading into Developmental Lenses and practical tools.

BY TOPIC Communication, learning, play, relationships, sleep, behavior, and emotional regulation.

Homepage story, in order

01 **Hero —** “See what’s growing.” / Explore a moment / Explore by age

02 **Lens preview —** A working interactive explanation, not a decorative carousel

03 **Age exploration —** The first five years, navigable by developmental context

04 **Three dimensions —** Understand your child, yourself, and your influence

05 **Hard moments —** Fast, calm support without a long educational detour

06 **Classes —** Structured depth, clearly separated by availability

07 **Tools + evidence —** A curated doorway to existing utilities and science resources

08 **Why trust us + invitation —** Founder credentials, transparent sources, a quiet final CTA

Preservation rule

Keep existing courses, access and payment flows, Growing Minds AI, Number Path, Milestone Tracker, Communication Snapshot, activities, reading prompts, hard-moment support, arcade, articles, guides, and evidence-graded claims. Audit routes and dependencies before redesign; do not silently rewrite backend systems.

09 / BUILDER HANDOFF

Make it beautiful. Make it useful.

Use these principles as operational guardrails for implementation, review, and future extensions.

Copy-and-use design tokens

```
--gms-ink: #193C39;           --gms-paper: #F7F4EC;
--gms-verdigris: #245F58;     --gms-sage: #E0EBE5;
--gms-clay: #C46C4D;          --gms-ochre: #D2A453;
--gms-research: #426B91;      --gms-white: #FFFDF8;
```

Recommended first sprint

- Inventory routes, components, course/payment/auth flows, evidence controls, and published content.
- Build the foundational tokens, typography, navigation, and reusable editorial components.
- Prototype the homepage plus one scientifically reviewed Developmental Lens.
- Validate mobile usability, keyboard access, WCAG contrast, reduced motion, performance, and existing workflow regressions.
- Keep publishing and risky infrastructure changes behind explicit approval.

Approval checklist

- Brand recognizable without a logo; no generic parenting visuals.
- One lead message per surface; four slogans used in their intended roles.
- The interface creates understanding rather than just visual novelty.
- Research uncertainty remains honest; no unsupported clinical claims.
- Mobile parent in a hurry can find immediate support quickly.
- Existing purchased classes and tools remain fully accessible.

THE FINAL STANDARD

The interface should be a teacher. The science should be visible. The parent should leave more capable than they arrived.